

अथ चतुर्थोऽध्यायः

ऋषिरुवाच ॥ १ ॥

शक्रादयः सुरगणा निहतेऽतिवीर्ये
तस्मिन्दुरात्मनि सुरारिवले च देव्या ।
तां तुष्टुवुः प्रणतिनम्रशिरोधरांसा
वाग्भिः प्रहर्षपुलकोद्गमचारुदेहाः ॥ २ ॥

देव्या यया ततमिदं जगदात्मशक्त्या
निःशेषदेवगणशक्तिसमूहमूर्त्या ।
तामम्बिकामखिलदेवमहर्षिपूज्यां
भक्त्या नताः स्म विदधातु शुभानि सा नः ॥ ३ ॥

1-2. The Rṣi said: When that most valiant but evil-natured Mahiṣāsura and the army of that foe of the devas were destroyed by the Devī, Indra and the hosts of devas uttered their words of praise, their necks and shoulders reverently bent, and bodies rendered beautiful with horripilation and exultation.

3. 'To that Ambikā who is worthy of worship by all devas and sages and pervades this world by her

यस्याः प्रभावमतुलं भगवाननन्तो
ब्रह्मा हरश्च न हि वक्तुमलं बलं च ।
सा चण्डिकाखिलजगत्परिपालनाय
नाशाय चाशुभभयस्य मतिं करोतु ॥ ४ ॥

या श्रीः स्वयं सुकृतिनां भवनेष्वलक्ष्मीः
पापात्मनां कृतधियां हृदयेषु बुद्धिः ।
श्रद्धा सतां कुलजनप्रभवस्य लज्जा
तां त्वां नताः स्म परिपालय देवि विश्वम् ॥ ५ ॥

power and who is the embodiment of the entire powers of all the hosts of devas, we bow in devotion. May she grant us auspicious things !

4. 'May Caṇḍikā, whose incomparable greatness and power Bhagavān Viṣṇu, Brahmā and Hara are unable to describe, bestow her mind on protecting the entire world and on destroying the fear of evil.

5. 'O Devī, we bow before you, who are yourself good fortune in the dwellings of the virtuous, and ill-fortune in those of the vicious, intelligence in the hearts of the learned, faith in the hearts of the good, and modesty in the hearts of the high-born. May you protect the universe !

किं वर्णयाम तव रूपमचिन्त्यमेतत्
 किञ्चातिवीर्यमसुरक्षयकारि भूरि ।
 किं चाहवेषु चरितानि तवाति यानि
 सर्वेषु देव्यसुरदेवगणादिकेषु ॥ ६ ॥

हेतुः समस्तजगतां त्रिगुणापि दोषैः
 न ज्ञायसे हरिहरादिभिरप्यपारा ।
 सर्वाश्रयाखिलमिदं जगदंशभूत-
 मव्याकृता हि परमा प्रकृतिस्त्वमाद्या ॥ ७ ॥

6. 'O Devī, how can we describe your inconceivable form, or your abundant surpassing valour that destroys the asuras, or your wonderful feats displayed in battles among all the hosts of gods, asuras and others ?

7. 'You are the origin of all the worlds ! Though you are possessed of the three guṇas¹ you are not known to have any of their attendant defects (like passion) ! You are incomprehensible even to Viṣṇu, Śiva and others ! You are the resort of all ! This entire world is composed of an infinitesimal portion of

1. Sattva, rajas and tamas of which the world is made.

यस्याः सप्तस्तसुरता समुदीरणेन
तृप्तिं प्रयाति सकलेषु मखेषु देवि ।
स्वाहासि वै पितृगणस्य च तृप्तिहेतु-
रुच्चार्यसे त्वमत एव जनैः स्वधा च ॥ ८ ॥

yourself! You are verily the supreme primordial Prakṛti² untransformed³.

8. 'O Devī, you are Svāhā⁴ at whose utterance the whole assemblage of gods attains satisfaction in all the sacrifices. You are the Svadhā⁵ which gives satisfaction to the manes. Therefore you are chanted (as Svāhā and Svadhā in Sacrifices) by people.

2. Creatrix or Nature. She is both with form and without form and is termed variously. She is called Prakṛti by the followers of Sāṅkhya, Avidyā by the Vedantins, Power of words by grammarians, Śakti of Śiva by Saivaites, Viṣṇumāyā by the Vaiṣṇavas, Mahāmāyā by the Śaktas and Devī by the Paurāṇikas.

3. Not subject to the six normal modes of transformation: birth, existence, growth, Change, decay and destruction; or not yet evolved into names and forms.

4. Svāhā is the mantra uttered in sacrifices to the gods.

5. Svadhā is the mantra uttered in the offerings to the manes.

या मुक्तिहेतुरविचिन्त्यमहाव्रता त्वं
 अभ्यस्यसे सुनियतेन्द्रियतत्त्वसारैः ।
 मोक्षार्थिभिर्मुनिभिरस्तसमस्तदोषै-
 र्विद्याऽसि सा भगवती परमा हि देवि ॥ ९ ॥

शब्दात्मिका सुविमलग्र्यजुषां निधान-
 मुद्गीथरम्यपदपाठवतां च साम्नाम् ।
 देवी त्रयी भगवती भवभावनाय
 वार्ता च सर्वजगतां परमार्तिहन्त्री ॥ १० ॥

9. 'O Devī, you are Bhagavatī, the supreme Vidyā⁶ which is the cause of liberation, and great inconceivable penances (are the means for your realization). You (the supreme knowledge) are cultivated by sages desiring liberation, whose senses are well restrained, who are devoted to Reality, and have shed all the blemishes.

10. 'You are the soul of S'abda-brahman. You are the repository of the very pure R̥c⁷ and Yajus hymns, and of sāmāns, the recital of whose words is beautiful with the Udgītha!⁸ You are Bhagavatī

6. Vidyā is the cause of liberation while avidyā is the cause of bondage.

7. The R̥g-veda, Yajur-veda and Sāma-veda are respectively the forms of Mahākālī, Mahālakṣmī, and Mahāsarasvatī.

8. Praṇava or Oṃkāra or the music of the Sāman.

मेधाऽसि देवि विदिताखिलशास्त्रसारा
दुर्गाऽसि दुर्गभवसागरनौरसङ्गा ।
श्रीः कैटभारिहृदयैककृताधिवासा
गौरी त्वमेव शशिमौलिकृतप्रतिष्ठा ॥ ११ ॥

ईषत्सहासममलं परिपूर्णचन्द्र-
बिम्बानुकारि कनकोत्तमकान्तिकान्तम् ।
अत्यद्भुतं ग्रहतमाचरुषा तथापि
वक्त्रं विलोक्य सहसा महिषासुरेण ॥ १२ ॥

embodying the three Vedas. And you are the sustenance whereby life is maintained. You are the supreme destroyer of the pain of all the worlds.

11. 'O Devī, you are the Intellect, by which the essence of all scriptures is comprehended. You are Durgā, the boat that takes men across the difficult ocean of worldly existence, devoid of attachments. You are S'rī⁹ who has invariably taken her abode in the heart of Viṣṇu. You are indeed Gaurī¹⁰ who has established herself with S'iva.

12. 'Gently smiling, pure, resembling the full moon's orb, beautiful like the splendour of excellent gold was your face! Yet it was very strange that, being swayed by anger, Mahiṣāsura suddenly struck your face when he saw it.

दृष्ट्वा तु देवि कुपितं भ्रुकुटीकराल-
 मुद्यच्छशाङ्कसदृशच्छवि यन्न सद्यः ।
 प्राणान् मुमोच महिषस्तदतीव चित्रं
 कैर्जीव्यते हि कुपितान्तकदर्शनेन ॥ १३ ॥

देवि प्रसीद परमा भवती भवाय
 सद्यो विनाशयसि कोपवती कुलानि ।
 विज्ञातमेतदधुनैव यदस्तमेतन्नीतं
 बलं सुविपुलं महिषासुरस्य ॥ १४ ॥

ते सम्मता जनपदेषु धनानि तेषां
 तेषां यशांसि न च सीदति धर्मवर्गः ।

13. 'Far strange it is that after seeing your wrathful face, O Devī, terrible with its frowns and red in hue like the rising moon, that Mahiṣāsura did not forthwith give up his life! For who can live after beholding the enraged destroyer ?

14. 'O Devī, be propitious. You are Supreme. If enraged, you forthwith destroy the (asura) families for the welfare (of the world). This was known the very moment when the extensive forces of Mahiṣāsura were brought to their end.

15. 'You who are always bounteous, with whom you are well pleased, those (fortunate ones) are indeed the object of esteem in the country, theirs are riches,

धन्यास्त एव निभृतात्मजभृत्यदारा
येषां सदाभ्युदयदा भवती प्रसन्ना ॥ १५ ॥

धर्म्याणि देवि सकलानि सदैव कर्मा-
प्यत्यादृतः प्रतिदिनं सुकृती करोति ।
स्वर्गं प्रयाति च ततो भवतीप्रसादा-
ल्लोकत्रयेऽपि फलदा ननु देवि तेन ॥ १६ ॥

दुर्गे स्मृता हरसि भीतिमशेषजन्तोः
स्वस्थः स्मृता मतिमतीव शुभां ददासि ।
दारिद्र्यदुःखभयहारिणि का त्वदन्या
सर्वोपकारकरणाय सदाद्र्चिता ॥ १७ ॥

theirs are glories, and their acts of righteousness perish not; they are indeed blessed and possessed of devoted children, servants and wives.

16. 'By your grace, O Devī, the blessed individual does daily all righteous deeds with utmost care, and thereby attains to heaven. Are You not therefore, O Devī, the bestower of reward in all the three worlds.

17. 'When called to mind in a difficult pass, you remove fear for every person. When called to mind by those in happiness, you bestow a mind still further pious. Which goddess but you, O Dispeller of poverty, pain and fear, has an ever sympathetic heart for helping everyone.

एभिर्हतैर्जगदुपैति सुखं तथैते
 कुर्वन्तु नाम नरकाय चिराय पापम् ।
 संग्राममृत्युमधिगम्य दिवं प्रयान्तु
 मत्वेति नूनमहितान्विनिहंसि देवि ॥ १८ ॥

दृष्ट्वैव किं न भवती प्रकरोति भस्म
 सर्वासुरानरिषु यत्प्रहिणोषि शस्त्रम् ।
 लोकान्प्रयान्तु रिपवोऽपि हि शस्त्रपूता
 इत्थं मतिर्भवति तेष्वपि तेऽतिसाध्वी ॥ १९ ॥

खड्गप्रभानिकरविस्फुरणैस्तथोग्रैः
 शूलाग्रकान्तिनिवहेन दृशोऽसुराणाम् ।

18. 'The world attains happiness by the killing of these (foes); and though these (asuras) have committed sins to keep them long in hell, let them reach heaven by meeting death eventually at the battle (with me)—thinking thus, that you, O Devī, certainly destroy our enemies.

19. 'Don't you reduce to ashes all asuras by mere sight? But you direct your weapons against them so that even the inimical ones, purified by the missiles, may attain to higher worlds. Such is your most kindly intention towards them.

20. 'If the eyes of the asuras had not been put out by the terrible flashes of the mass of light issuing from your sword or by the copious lustre of your

यन्नागता विलयमंशुमदिन्दुखण्ड-
योग्याननं तव विलोकयतां तदेतत् ॥ २० ॥

दुर्वृत्तवृत्तशमनं तव देवि शीलं
रूपं तथैतदविचिन्त्यमतुल्यमन्यैः ।
वीर्यं च हन्तु हृतदेवपराक्रमाणां
वैरिष्वपि प्रकटितैव दया त्वयेत्यम् ॥ २१ ॥

केनोपमा भवतु तेऽस्य पराक्रमस्य
रूपं च शत्रुभयकार्यतिहारि कुत्र ।
चित्ते कृपा समरनिष्ठुरता च दृष्टा
त्वय्येव देवि वरदे भुवनत्रयेऽपि ॥ २२ ॥

spearpoint, it is because they saw also your face resembling moon, giving out (cool) rays.

21. 'O Devī, Your nature is to subdue the conduct of the wicked; this your peerless beauty is inconceivable for others; your power destroys those who have robbed the devas of their prowess, and you have thus manifested your compassion even towards the enemies.

22. 'What is your prowess to be compared to? Where can one find this beauty (of yours) most charming, (yet) striking fear in enemies? Compassion in heart and relentlessness in battle are seen, O Devī! O Bestower of boons! only in you in all the three worlds!

त्रैलोक्यमेतदखिलं रिपुनाशनेन
 त्रातं त्वया समरमूर्धनि तेऽपि हत्वा ।
 नीता दिवं रिपुगणा भयमप्यपास्त-
 मस्माकमुन्मदसुरारिभवं नमस्ते ॥ २३ ॥

शूलेन पाहि नो देवि पाहि खड्गेन चाम्बिके ।
 घण्टास्वनेन नः पाहि चापज्यानिस्स्वनेन च ॥ २४ ॥

प्राच्यां रक्ष प्रतीच्यां च चण्डिके रक्ष दक्षिणे ।
 भ्रामणेनात्मशूलस्य उत्तरस्यां तथेश्वरि ॥ २५ ॥

23. 'Through the destruction of the enemies all these three worlds have been saved by you. Having killed them in the battle-front, you have led even those hosts of enemies to heaven, and you have dispelled our fear from the frenzied enemies of the devas.' Salutation to you !

24. 'O Devī, protect us with your spear. O Ambikā, protect us with your sword, protect us by the sound of your bell and by the twang of your bow-string.

25. 'O Candikā, guard us in the east, in the west, in the north and in the south by the brandishing of your spear, O Īswari !

सौम्यानि यानि रूपाणि त्रैलोक्ये विचरन्ति ते ।
यानि चात्यन्तघोराणि तै रक्षास्मांस्तथा भुवम् ॥ २६ ॥

खड्गशूलगदादीनि यानि चास्त्राणि तेऽम्बिके ।
करपल्लवसङ्गीनि तैस्मात्रक्ष सर्वतः ॥ २७ ॥

ऋषिरुवाच ॥ २८ ॥

एवं स्तुता सुरैर्दिव्यैः कुसुमैर्नन्दनोद्भवैः ।
अर्चिता जगतां धात्री तथा गन्धानुलेपनैः ॥ २९ ॥

26. 'Protect us and the earth with those lovely forms of yours moving about in the three worlds, as also with your excludingly terrible forms.

27. 'O Ambikā, protect us on every side with your sword, spear and club and whatever other weapons your sprout-like (soft) hand has touched.'

28-30. The Rṣi said: Thus the supporter of the worlds was praised by the devas, worshipped with celestial flowers that blossomed in Nandana¹¹ and with perfumes¹² and unguents; and with devotion all of them, offered her—heavenly incense. Benignly

11. Name of the flower-garden in heaven.

12. Kumkuma, Aguru, Kastūri, (musk), Candana (sandal) and Karpūra (camphor) are the five great perfumes used in ritual worship.

भक्त्या समस्तस्त्रिदशैर्दिव्यैर्धूपैः सुधूपिता ।
 ग्राह प्रसादसुमुखी समस्तान् प्रणतान् सुरान् ॥ ३० ॥

देव्युवाच ॥ ३१ ॥

त्रियतां त्रिदशाः सर्वे यदस्मत्तोऽभिवाञ्छितम् ॥ ३२ ॥
 (ददाम्यहमतिप्रीत्या स्तवैरेभिः सुपूजिता ।)

देवा ऊचुः ॥ ३३ ॥

भगवत्या कृतं सर्वं न किञ्चिदवशिष्यते ।
 यदयं निहतः शत्रुस्माकं महिषासुरः ॥ ३४ ॥
 यदि चापि वरो देयस्त्वयाऽस्माकं महेश्वरि ।
 संस्मृता संस्मृता त्वं नो हिंसेथाः परमापदः ॥ ३५ ॥

serene in countenance she spoke to all obeisant devas.

31-32. The Devī said: Choose all of you, O devas, whatever you desire of me. (Gratified immensely with these hymns, I grant it with great pleasure.)

33-34. The devas said: Since our enemy, this Mahiṣāsura, has been slain by Bhagavatī (i.e. you) everything has been accomplished, and nothing remains to be done.

35. And if a boon is to be granted to us by you, O Mahesvarī, whenever we think of you again destroy our direct calamities.

यश्च मर्त्यः स्तवैरेभिस्त्वां स्तोष्यत्यमलानने ।

तस्य वित्तर्द्धिविभवैर्धनदारादिसम्पदाम् ॥ ३६ ॥

वृद्धयेऽस्मत्प्रसन्ना त्वं भवेथाः सर्वदाम्बिके ॥ ३७ ॥

ऋषिरुवाच ॥ ३८ ॥

इति प्रसादिता देवैर्जगतोऽर्थे तथात्मनः ।

तथेत्युक्त्वा भद्रकाली बभूवान्तर्हिता नृप ॥ ३९ ॥

36-37. O Mother of spotless countenance, and whatever mortal shall praise you with these hymns, may you, who have become gracious towards us, be also for his increase in his wealth, wife, and other fortunes together with riches, prosperity and life, O Ambikā !

38-39. The Rṣi said: O King, being thus propitiated by the devas for the sake of the world and for their own sake, Bhadrakālī said, 'Be it so' and vanished from their sight.¹³

13. The Devi granted the two prayers of the devas. She is therefore, bound by her promise to extend her saving grace to us whenever we call on her in weal and woe.

इत्येतत्कथितं भूप सम्भूता सा यथा पुरा ।
देवी देवशरीरेभ्यो जगत्त्रयहितैषिणी ॥ ४० ॥

पुनश्च गौरीदेहा सा समुद्भूता यथामवत् ।
वधाय दुष्टदैत्यानां तथा शुम्भनिशुम्भयोः ॥ ४१ ॥

रक्षणाय च लोकानां देवानामुपकारिणी ।
तच्छृणुष्व मयाख्यातं यथावत्कथयामि ते ॥ ४२ ॥

इति श्रीमार्कण्डेयपुराणे सावर्णिके मन्वन्तरे देवीमाहात्म्ये
शक्रादिस्तुतिर्नाम चतुर्थोऽध्यायः ॥ ४ ॥

40. Thus have I narrated, O King, how the Devi who desires the good of all the three worlds made her appearance of yore out of the bodies of the devas.

41-42. And again how, as a benefactress of the devas, she appeared in the form of Gauri for the slaying of wicked asuras as well as S'umbha and Nisumbha, and for the protection of worlds, listen as I relate it: I shall tell it to you as it happened.

Here ends the fourth chapter called 'Praises by
S'akra and others' of Devīmāhātmya in
Mārkaṇḍeya-purāṇa, during the period
of Sāvarni, the Manu.

